

The 60-Second Vintage Watch Check

Seven questions to ask before you buy any vintage watch, online or at a market.

- ☐ **1 A clear photo of the caseback?**
No photo, no deal. The reference and serial live there.
- ☐ **2 Reference and serial match?**
They must fit the model in the title and its production years.
- ☐ **3 Dial print sharp and even?**
Thick, blurry or wobbly text is the classic sign of a redial.
- ☐ **4 Lume the same age everywhere?**
Dial and hands should age together. Fresh hands on an old dial mean swapped parts.
- ☐ **5 Case edges crisp?**
Soft, rounded lines mean heavy polishing. You cannot put the metal back.
- ☐ **6 Any of these words in the listing?**
Refurbished, restored, new dial. Price it as a parts watch.
- ☐ **7 Who is selling?**
Check feedback and the returns policy. Buy the seller, not the watch.

The golden rule: asking prices lie, sold prices do not.

Search the exact reference on eBay, filter by Sold items and look at the last 10 to 20 results. If the watch in front of you costs more, you need a very good reason.